

D.J. PARIS

YOUR PHOTOS HAVE THE BLINDS HALF SHUT.

None of what's wrong in your listing photos costs money to fix.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**BUYERS DECIDE IF
THEY WANT TO SEE
YOUR LISTING
BEFORE THEY EVER
PICK UP THE
PHONE.**

The photos are the first showing. Most listings lose buyers there and never find out why.

THE ROOMS AREN'T SMALL. THE PHOTOS JUST SAY THEY ARE.

Half-closed blinds cut the light out of every room in the shot. A couch pushed against the window blocks it further. A bed with no headboard reads as unfinished. None of that costs a dollar to change. It costs an afternoon walking the house before the photographer shows up. But buyers never see the fix, only the listing they scrolled past because the rooms looked dark and cramped.

WALK THE HOUSE WITH THIS LIST BEFORE EVERY LISTING SHOOT:

- 1 Pull every blind all the way up.**
Twisting the slats open is not the same thing. Open light fills a room; angled slats still block most of it.
- 2 Move furniture off the walls.**
A few inches of gap around a couch or bed makes a room read bigger in a photo than it does in person.
- 3 Take the couch out from in front of the window.**
It blocks the light source the room is supposed to be selling.
- 4 Give every bedroom a headboard and two lamps.**
Borrow them if you have to. A bed with no headboard reads as staged badly, not staged at all.

THE TAKEAWAY

**BEFORE THE
PHOTOS GO UP,
WALK EVERY
ROOM WITH THE
BLINDS ALL THE
WAY OPEN.**